Cyber2You: An interactive Mailing List to Raise Cyber Literacy Awareness

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1. Introduction:

Cybersecurity plays a significant role in modern life: work, education, banking, healthcare and public services. Its vital presence demands cyber-literacy, awareness and secure online behaviours by individuals as access to technology bourgeons. Yet still, public understanding of fundamental digital safety practices remains lowly explored. Leading to an upsurge in phishing, online scams, identity theft and data breach.

1. Only 56% of EU citizens between the age 16-74 have basic digital skills with significant difference among nations and age categories (h, 2025)

2. Both public and private sector were impacted by the sudden upsurge (a 50% increase in threat actor activity) of cyber incidents that they were ill-equipped to deal with (NCSC, 2023)

Cyber Literacy plays an equally essential part to Cyber Security Solutions, being only as effective as those using them and less effectively idly in the background or dismissed and ignored. Improving cybersecurity awareness is a pivotal first step and a societal priority across Europe and United Kingdom.

This project provides one such simple and feasible solution that could have a huge impact in minimising this issue through an interactive email-based campaign. The Cyber2You project intends to increase staff, student and public awareness and knowledge of cybersecurity with tests, easy to understand breakdowns and engaging graphics and style.

2. Aims and Objective

Aims:

The primary aim of the Cyber2You project is to raise awareness of essential cybersecurity concepts among students, employees, and the general public, helping users recognise and mitigate common online threats such as phishing, fraud, and data breaches. The project seeks to empower individuals to take greater responsibility for their own digital security by providing regular, practical, and easily actionable guidance. It also aims to embed cybersecurity education into everyday online activities within academic and professional environments, fostering a culture of responsibility and digital literacy. Ultimately, Cyber2You supports the long-term digital safety goals of the United Kingdom and Europe by equipping citizens with the foundational knowledge required to navigate technology securely and build trust in digital systems.

Objectives:

Objective 1: Improve cybersecurity awareness and engagement

S (Specific):

Develop and distribute a weekly email campaign that includes a "Cyber Fact of the Day," a weekly real-world case study, and short, actionable security tips to increase users' knowledge of cybersecurity best practices.

M (Measurable):

Increase the average email open rate by 15% and click-through rate by 10% within the first six months.

Achieve a minimum email distribution list growth of 20% by the end of the year.

Attain an average positive feedback score of 80% or higher from user surveys conducted bi-annually.

A (Achievable):

The project is achievable with dedicated resources for content creation, email platform management, and user outreach. The content variety keeps it engaging and relevant to users.

R (Relevant):

Enhancing user awareness is a crucial step towards improving institutional cybersecurity posture and reducing human-error-related security incidents.

T (Time-bound):

Launch the campaign within three months and report on progress at six-month intervals over a one-year period.

Objective 2: Assess and improve user cybersecurity knowledge

S (Specific):

Administer monthly and weekly quizzes to users to help them assess their cybersecurity expertise and track their progress over time.

M (Measurable):

- Increase the average quiz score by 20% over a one-year period.
- Achieve a minimum of 75% user participation in the monthly quizzes.
- Reduce the average number of incorrect answers on key security topics by 30% after six months.

A (Achievable):

This is attainable by leveraging online quiz tools and integrating them with the email campaign platform. The format is designed for continuous, low-friction engagement.

R (Relevant):

Regular testing and feedback provide users with a clear understanding of their knowledge gaps, reinforcing the educational content and validating the campaign's effectiveness.

T (Time-bound):

Implement the testing program within four months of the campaign launch. Conduct the first annual progress review at the 2-month mark.

Objective 3: Evaluate campaign impact for scalability

S (Specific):

Collect, analyze, and report on campaign engagement rates, user feedback, and quiz performance to assess its overall effectiveness and potential for wider adoption.

M (Measurable):

1. Conduct quarterly reporting on key metrics, including engagement rates, survey responses, and quiz scores.
2. Present a comprehensive scalability assessment at the one-year mark, including recommendations for wider institutional implementation.
3. Achieve a campaign satisfaction rating of at least 85% in the end-of-year user survey.

A (Achievable):

This is a realistic goal that uses standard analytics tools for email, website forms, and quiz platforms. The data collected will provide the necessary evidence for future investment.

R (Relevant):

Evaluating the campaign's impact is essential for understanding the return on investment and securing support for broader rollout across an institution or multiple organizations.

T (Time-bound):

Establish a review schedule for reporting quarterly throughout the campaign's first year, with a final assessment and recommendation report completed by the end of the year.

3. Technology & Resources

Table 1: Summary of Resources & Technology

Technology / Resource	Purpose / Function	Notes
Cloud Email Server	To send quizzes and informational ("infomail") content to participants.	Enables high-volume secure email distribution and supports authentication (SPF, DKIM) for reliability.
Social Media Platforms	Managed from a central hub to ensure widespread reach and engagement.	Extends campaign visibility and allows public feedback and discussion around cybersecurity awareness topics.
Google Forms / Typeform	Used to create interactive quizzes that provide instant scoring and collect qualitative feedback.	Facilitates self-assessment and enables data export for engagement analysis.
Partnerships with Cybersecurity Forums (e.g., KU Cyber Society)	Collaboration to promote key cybersecurity topics and ensure relevant, accurate content.	Supports community engagement, provides authentic case studies, and ensures non-PII data sharing compliance.
N8NChat (or similar AI Workflow Builder)	Automates repetitive tasks such as generating forms, icons, colours, layouts, and managing mailing lists.	Enhances operational efficiency; outputs are manually reviewed by the project team to ensure accuracy and tone consistency.
Mailchimp (or similar Email Delivery Platform)	Manages bulk email distribution and automates scheduled messages using the cloud email server.	Offers scalable templates, analytics, and GDPR-compliant audience management.

Technologies and resources utilised in the Cyber2You project, outlining their core functions and roles in supporting campaign delivery, automation, and compliance.

4. Competitors

Table2: Competitor SWOT analysis

Competitors	Strength	Weakness	Opportunities	Threat
KnowBe4 https://www.knowbe4.com/?utm_source=chatgpt.com	Market-leader in security awareness training and simulated phishing Large content library, proven results (e.g., reduction in phish-prone behaviour).	- Mostly targeted at organisations/corporates rather than general public or educational settings - Potentially high cost relative to a smaller campaign like yours	- You can position your project as more accessible or low-cost for education/public sphere - Possible to draw inspiration or partner with parts of their content	- Their scale and brand credibility may out-compete your project - They might expand into your target area (education / public demographic)
CybSafe (https://www.cybsafe.com)	Strong behavioural-science approach, adaptive human risk management platform. - UK/Europe relevant (addresses GDPR/NIS etc) which aligns with your region.	- Again, likely comercial pricing and setup complexity - Possibly more complex than a simple email-campaign model	Your project can highlight simplicity and accessibility for non-corporate audiences - Use their insights on behaviour change to inform your campaign design	- They could target education audiences too - If users expect high end features (behavioural analytics), your simpler solution might appear less sophisticated

Comparison of major cybersecurity awareness platforms—KnowBe4 and CybSafe—evaluating their strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats in relation to the Cyber2You project. This analysis highlights market positioning, scalability, and the potential for differentiation within the education and public-awareness sectors.

4. Method and Workplan

To create, carry out, and assess the email-based cybersecurity awareness campaign, the Cyber2You project will use a mixed-methods approach, integrating qualitative and quantitative data collecting and analysis. To guarantee a methodical and quantifiable research process, the technique is divided into three successive phases.

Phase 1

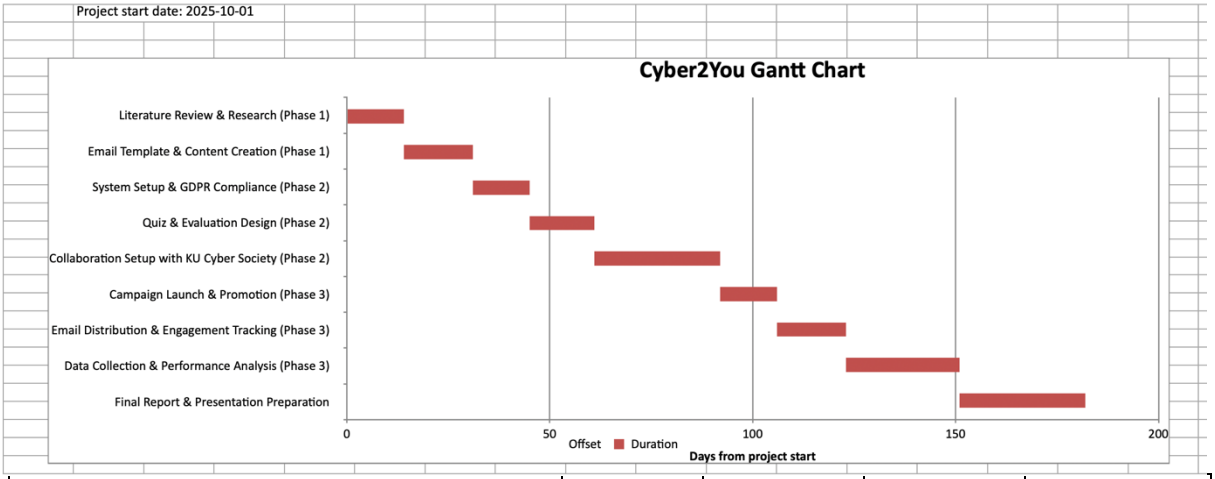
A thorough literature analysis of previous studies on cybersecurity awareness, behavioural change theory, and effective educational communication will be part of the first step, planning and design. At the same time, the first email content will be created, which will include templates for the weekly case studies, the "Cyber Fact of the Day," and practical security advice.

Phase 2

The project's construction will be the main goal of the second phase, Development and Setup. This entails writing the first set of email content and creating related weekly and monthly tests to let users assess themselves. The mailing list will be set up on the selected platform with secure data processing practices and explicit permission processes to ensure GDPR compliance. To prepare the advertising effort for participant recruitment, a formal collaboration with the KU Cyber Society will be established.

Phase 3

The promotional effort will begin in the third phase, Implementation and Monitoring. Subscribers will get the scheduled emails over a predetermined time frame (e.g., 8–12 weeks). To increase the audience, the KU Cyber Society promotional campaign will be implemented. Important engagement data, including email open rates, click-through rates, and quiz participation rates, will be tracked and recorded continually throughout this phase.



Task	Phase	Start	Finish	Duration (days)
Literature Review & Research (Phase 1)	Phase 1	2025-10-01	2025-10-14	14
Email Template & Content Creation (Phase 1)	Phase 1	2025-10-15	2025-10-31	17
System Setup & GDPR Compliance (Phase 2)	Phase 2	2025-11-01	2025-11-14	14
Quiz & Evaluation Design (Phase 2)	Phase 2	2025-11-15	2025-11-30	16
Collaboration Setup with KU Cyber Society (Phase 2)	Phase 2	2025-12-01	2025-12-31	31
Campaign Launch & Promotion (Phase 3)	Phase 3	2026-01-01	2026-01-14	14
Email Distribution & Engagement Tracking (Phase 3)	Phase 3	2026-01-15	2026-01-31	17
Data Collection & Performance Analysis (Phase 3)	Phase 3	2026-02-01	2026-02-28	28
Final Report & Presentation Preparation	Evaluation	2026-03-01	2026-03-31	31

5. Legal, Ethical, Societal, GDPR and Security Consideration

The cyber2you project works with strict ethical guidelines to guarantee participants data is handled responsibly and data protection law are followed. The project complies with the UK Data protection Act 2018 and EU General Data protections regulation (GDPR) which both emphasis on informed consent, transparency, data minimisation, and the right to erasure, as it gathers and handles personal data, including email addresses and quiz answers (Cabinet Office, 2021b) Participants will receive comprehensive about the project's objectives, the use of their data, and their freedom to discontinue participation at any moment. All information will be anonymously kept on servers that comply with GDPR and secured by access controls.

The project refers to the moral values of freedom, fairness, and respect. No identifying information will be shared with anybody outside the study team, and participation is completely voluntary. The educational resources will promote safe online conducts while avoiding gender or cultural stereotypes and being inclusive and free of bias. To guarantee compliance with institutional standards, ethical approval will be requested via Kingston university research ethics framework.

From a societal perspective Cyber2You support the UK National Cyber Security Strategy 2022 objectives of cultivating a "cyber resilient society" by allowing individuals to make educated digital decisions. The project helps to improve public trust in technology use and reduced cyber vulnerability at the local level. To reduce the risks of unauthorised access, phishing, or data leakage, security will be put in place, such as encrypted communications, access controls and recurring audits. When taken these legal ethical societal, GDPR, and security measures guarantee that cyber2you functions as a legitimate law abiding and socially conscious cybersecurity awareness campaign.

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